

The Slumdog Phenomenon

MARCH 2, 2009

First class upgrades. Stretch limos. Celebrity chat show appearances. Four Golden Globes, one SAG Award, seven BAFTAs. Poverty porn or just a very smart movie in a depressing year, *Slumdog Millionaire*'s ride looks all set to continue.



“ This year's Oscars have been an exception to the rule that the West is the best. Criticised by many, *Slumdog* won for its brilliance. It showcased the hues of India and celebrated unity in diversity. ”

MAHESH KAPASI, via www.indiatoday.in

The Big O

One cannot deny the fact that *Slumdog Millionaire* has put India's celluloid glory on the global stage, raking up unwanted controversies but still bagging prestigious awards. Whether one likes it or not, one cannot ignore this movie that shows how we revel in false pride while ignoring the fact that poverty plagues our nation, even though as a country we have prospered economically. One hopes *Slumdog Millionaire* is an eye-opener for every Indian and moves people to make a sincere effort to improve the lives of the marginalised.

K. CHIDANAND KUMAR,
via www.indiatoday.in

Danny Boyle has managed to do the impossible. His



Populist Measures

The common man has little to cheer over Pranab Mukherjee's budget ("The Debt Trap", March 2). Even though the Government has done all it can to bring down interest rates and flush the system with liquidity, the economy will take long to recover from the huge financial mess that the Government is leaving it in.

KUSHAL PANDEY, via www.indiatoday.in

The interim rail budget is definitely populist ("Lalu's Bihar Express", March 2). It will please the common man who in turn will pay back with votes. Although many new trains were introduced during Lalu Prasad Yadav's tenure as the Railways minister, there are very few that connect Saurashtra, in Gujarat, with other major cities.

K.D. NAG, via www.indiatoday.in

Slumdog Millionaire's astounding award spree has left the world in gasps, but has little for us to identify with—neither the choice of the theme nor the inclusion of a few Indians in its making. The hype and hoopla it has generated in the West is possibly because it conforms to their image of India—indigent and driven by luck rather than enterprise.

Y.G. CHOUKSEY,
via www.indiatoday.in

Business of Politics

People enter politics only to amass wealth and not to serve people ("Rich Politicians", February 23). Politics pays rich dividends and the business of politicians is unaffected by global recession. Little wonder that politicians are growing

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